Daily Economic Briefing

Monday 26 October 2026 | Window: Thu 22 Oct 2026 20:00 ET – Sun 25 Oct 2026 20:21 ET (Fri 23 Oct close/AH, the window's one NYSE session) | Research cutoff Sun 25 Oct 2026 20:21 ET | Edition 49

60-second read

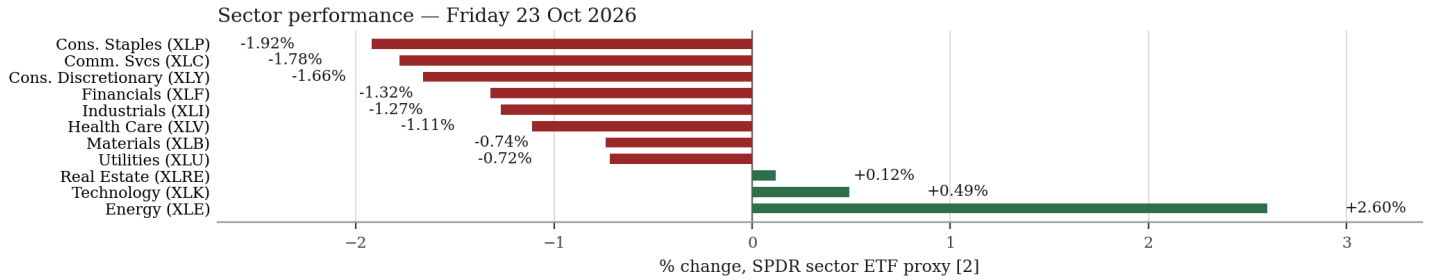
1. A modest, narrow risk-off Friday: S&P 500 -0.52% to 7,623.68, Dow -1.24% to 52,215.16 (the session's worst of the majors), Nasdaq Composite -0.23%, Nasdaq-100 essentially flat, Russell 2000 -0.33%[1] — only Energy, Technology and Real Estate closed higher (3 of 11 SPDR sectors), with Consumer Staples the laggard.[2]
2. Oil ripped higher into the weekend even as equities sold off: WTI +3.82% to $103.27, Brent +3.14% to $116.72[3] — a clean equity/commodity divergence this edition could not pin to one dateable Friday catalyst beyond October's already-elevated Middle East risk premium.
3. A packed earnings morning cut both ways: SLB's beat-and-dividend (+7.08%) led gainers while Bloom Energy's blowout quarter still fell -11.24% on profit-taking, American Express's beat-and-raise fell -3.68%, and AT&T slid a fresh, uncatalyzed -7.96% — a tape punishing good news on a down day.[4]
4. The FOMC's October 27-28 decision is now imminent, 1-2 days past this edition's cutoff. Rate markets price a hold at approx. 94%, unchanged from last edition, with blackout holding clean[5]; the Bank of Canada and the ECB both also decide this same week.[6][7]
5. Fresh CFTC data (as of Tue 20 Oct) show leveraged funds covering a meaningful chunk of their S&P net-short while staying net-short Russell 2000 and roughly flat Nasdaq-100[8] — a tactical de-risking concentrated in large-caps that has not yet reached small-caps, worth watching into the Fed decision.

1. Market recap

S&P 500	Dow Jones	Nasdaq Comp.	Nasdaq-100	Russell 2000	VIX
7,623.68	**52,215.16**	**25,955.34**	**28,957.53**	**approx. 2,773.8**	**19.45**
-0.52%	-1.24%	-0.23%	-0.00%	-0.33%	+2.21%

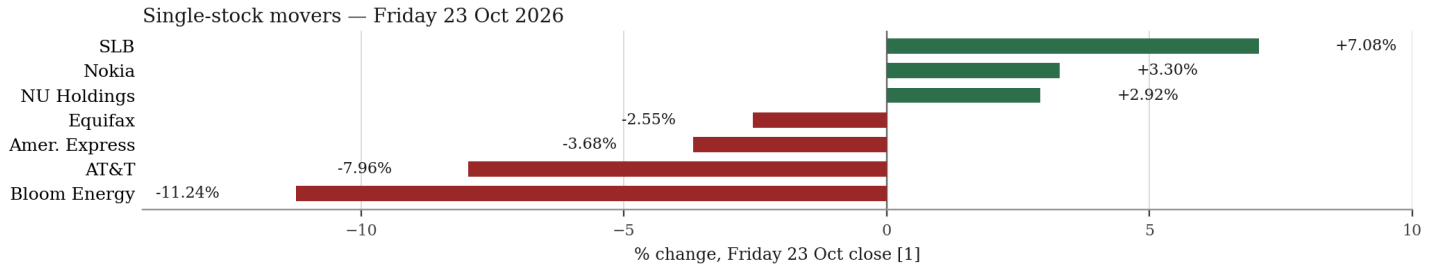
Friday 23 October closed a narrow, modestly negative session. AP's and Reuters' wires were not indexed/fetchable for Friday by this edition's cutoff, so index levels are sourced via the established fallback: stockanalysis.com's ETF-proxy data (SPY/DIA/ONEQ/QQQ/IWM) cross-checked against a direct-index snapshot source (StatMuse) and FRED's daily Nasdaq-100 series — the two methods agreed to within approx. 0.01pp on every index checked.[1] The Dow's -1.24% was the worst percentage move of the majors, weighed down by American Express's post-earnings slide; the Nasdaq-100 finished essentially flat. The Russell 2000 level remains ETF-proxy-derived only (no direct RUT snapshot found this edition) — see Annex B.

Sector performance



3 of 11 SPDR sectors closed higher.[2] Energy (XLE +2.60%) led on both the crude rally above and SLB's earnings beat; Technology (XLK +0.49%) and Real Estate (XLRE +0.12%) were the only other gainers. Consumer Staples (XLP -1.92%) brought up the rear with no single same-day staples catalyst identified — a continuation of the sector's weaker October tone rather than a dateable Friday event. Communication Services (-1.78%) and Consumer Discretionary (-1.66%) plausibly reflect continued digestion of the prior week's mega-cap tech/consumer earnings cluster (Meta, Netflix, Tesla all reported Tue-Wed), though this read-through is not independently confirmed for Friday specifically.

2. Equities and earnings



Ticker	Move	Driver
SLB	+7.08%	Q3 2026: revenue $9.45bn (+6% y/y), GAAP EPS $0.49, adjusted EPS $0.64 (beat approx. $0.62 consensus), FCF $828m, dividend maintained at $0.295/sh. The session's largest confirmed single-name driver of sector leadership.[9]
Nokia	+3.30%	Earnings call highlighted AI/cloud-related sales up 123%.[4]
NU Holdings	+2.92%	No single confirmed driver found; one aggregator's claimed +3.5% figure does not match the verified closing-price table — use the table figure.[4]
Equifax	-2.55%	Partial pullback after an unexplained, approx. +18% cumulative three-session rally (Tue 20 +11.33% on its own Q3 beat, Wed 21 flat, Thu 22 +6.59%). A fourth straight search pass (incl. SEC EDGAR full-text search) found no catalyst for Thursday's +6.59% leg — carried to Annex B.[10]

American Express	-3.68%	Record Q3 revenue $20.1bn (+9% y/y), GAAP EPS $5.42 (+31%), adjusted EPS $4.68 (+13%, above approx. $4.59-4.60 consensus), FY guidance raised — a clean beat-and-raise that still sold off within Financials' broadly weak (-1.32%) session; no specific sell-the-news driver identified beyond that.[9]
AT&T	-7.96%	A fresh, separate decline from Wednesday 21 Oct's disputed earnings-day drop (AT&T actually bounced +3.79% Thursday before this slide). No Friday-specific catalyst (downgrade, filing) found despite a dedicated search; peer Verizon fell only -1.19% same day, so this was not a sector-wide move. Logged to Annex B.[4]
Bloom Energy	-11.24%	Reported after Thursday's close: revenue $1,235.8m (+138.1% y/y), GAAP EPS $0.78, non-GAAP EPS $0.94, FY26 revenue guidance raised to $4.4-4.6bn. Despite the beat-and-raise, Friday's full regular session fell sharply — read as valuation/profit-taking after a large prior run rather than a guidance disappointment.[9]

A third-party earnings-calendar aggregator listed Chevron, Exxon Mobil, AbbVie and Newell Brands as Friday 23 Oct reporters; none of the four had actually reported by this edition's cutoff — Exxon, AbbVie and Newell Brands are each confirmed via their own investor calendars to report 30 October, and no Chevron 8-K exists for the window. Treat all four as not-yet-reported going into edition 50.[11] New Mexico v. Meta's $25bn civil-penalty ruling (21 Oct) remains open on two sub-questions for a third straight edition: whether the 9 October stay of enforcement extends to this judgment, and whether Meta has filed a formal notice of appeal — Meta's own counsel describes confidence in prevailing "on appeal" without confirming a filing date. Both logged to Annex B.[12]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Central bank	Policy rate	Last change	Next decision
Federal Reserve	3.75%-4.00%	+25bp, 16 Sept 2026 (12-0)	27-28 Oct 2026 (decision pending)
Bank of England	3.75%	held, 17 Sept 2026 (6-3)	5 Nov 2026
Bank of Japan	approx. 1.25% (secondary-sourced; primary statement PDF unreadable, 5th straight edition)	+25bp, 18 Sept 2026 (7-2), eff. 24 Sept	29-30 Oct 2026
European Central Bank	2.50% deposit facility (refi 2.65%, marginal lending 2.90%)	in effect since 16 Sept 2026[13]	approx. 28-29 Oct 2026 (secondary-sourced)
Norges Bank	4.50%	+25bp, 24 Sept 2026	not re-confirmed this edition — Annex B
Riksbank	approx. 1.75% (secondary-sourced; rate text not extractable from a now-working riksbank.se URL)	held, 24 Sept 2026	not re-confirmed this edition — Annex B
Swiss National Bank	0%	held, 24 Sept 2026	not re-confirmed this edition — Annex B
Reserve Bank of Australia	4.60%	+25bp, 29 Sept 2026 (unanimous)	not re-confirmed this edition — Annex B
Bank of Canada	2.25%	n/a this edition	28 Oct 2026, 9:45am ET[14]
Banco de México	6.50%	held, 24 Sept 2026	not re-confirmed this edition — Annex B

The FOMC's 27-28 October meeting sits 1-2 days past this edition's cutoff and remains inside its confirmed blackout window, with no leaks or Fed-speaker commentary found.[5] DeFi Rate's blended aggregator puts an October hold at approx. 94% (hike approx. 6%, unchanged from last edition); December odds show the same internal table-vs-table inconsistency flagged for two straight editions — a standalone figure of approx. 76% hike probability against a meeting-path table showing approx. 79% on the same page, both slightly higher than last edition's 72/77 split.[6] Kalshi's direct feed failed a 13th straight edition (rate-limited) and official CME FedWatch failed a 9th straight edition (blocked); both are worked around via DeFi Rate.[6] Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's exact term-end date, open since edition 48, is now resolved via a direct federalreserve.gov bios-page fetch: his Chairman term ends 21 May 2030 (took office 22 May 2026); his separate term as a Board Governor runs to 31 January 2040.[15] The ECB's current policy rate, unresolved at edition 48 on a 2.00%-vs-2.40% conflict, is now cleanly resolved via a direct ecb.europa.eu fetch at 2.50% deposit facility — neither of the previously conflicting figures was current.[13] The Bank of Canada's 28 October decision and 2.25% current rate are now primary-confirmed via bankofcanada.ca, closing an edition-48 secondary-sourcing gap; it lands the same day as the FOMC decision.[14] University of Michigan's final October consumer sentiment printed 48.0 (vs. September's final 48.1 and the preliminary 46.3, beating the approx. 47.6 consensus), with year-ahead inflation expectations at 4.7% and long-run expectations at 3.5% — secondary-sourced across three independent outlets after umich.edu itself could not be fetched directly; sub-index figures (current conditions 46.7, expectations 48.8) carry a lower confidence tier, single-aggregator only.[16] US government funding was reconfirmed unchanged via the standing whitehouse.gov URL: H.R. 6500 funds federal agencies through 11 December 2026, no shutdown.[17]

4. Commodities and FX

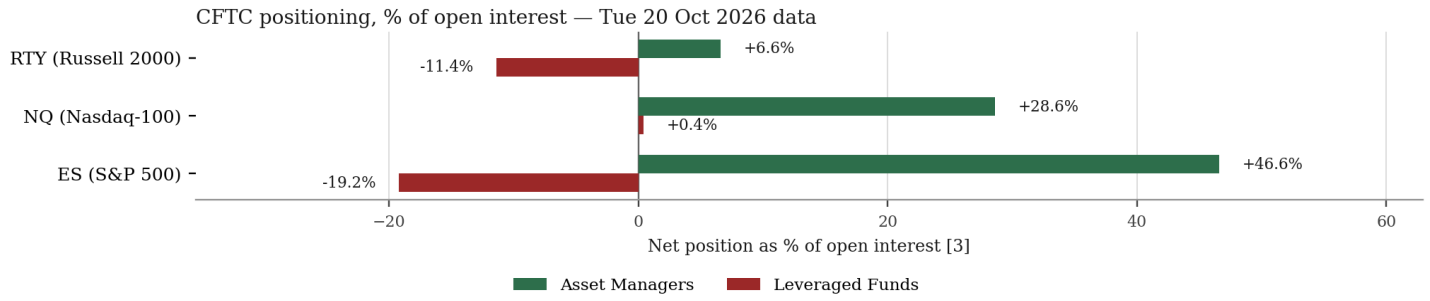
Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	$103.27	+3.82%	Thu 22 Oct base revised to $99.47 from this report's logged $99.28 (+0.19); no Friday-specific catalyst found beyond October's elevated Middle East risk premium.[3]
Brent crude	$116.72	+3.14%	Thu 22 Oct base unchanged at $113.17 — clean reconciliation.[3]
Henry Hub nat gas (NGX6, Nov-26 front month)	$2.640	-5.58%	OHLC internally consistent both sessions; Thu 22 Oct level ($2.796 fresh vs. $2.779 logged) shows a small, immaterial drift.[3]
Gold (COMEX futures)	$4,007.90	-1.29%	Thu 22 Oct base revised to $4,060.40 from this report's logged $4,038.35 (+$22) — a second straight edition of upward revision. Kitco spot sits approx. $20 below the futures close, a normal basis.[3]
Silver (COMEX futures)	$53.949	-1.92%	Thu 22 Oct base revised to $55.007 from logged $54.61 (+$0.40), same pattern as gold. Kitco spot basis normal.[3]
Copper (LME cash)	$14,415/tonne	+1.41%	westmetall.com is back online after a one-edition outage (expired-certificate issue was transient). COMEX futures cross-check agrees directionally (+1.71%).[3]
DXY	101.65 (futures)	+0.20%	Thu 22 Oct base (-0.16/-0.17% fresh vs. -0.21% logged) within normal cross-vendor noise.[3]

EUR/USD	1.1203	-0.12%	Thu 22 Oct base (1.1216 fresh vs. 1.1221 logged) immaterial, 5-pip drift.[3]
GBP/USD	1.3373	-0.21%	Thu 22 Oct base reconciled exactly to the logged 1.3401 — clean for a 5th straight edition.[3]
USD/JPY	156.87	+0.06%	Thu 22 Oct base revised to 156.77 from logged 156.54 (+23 pips) — the vendor-revision trap's locus rotating to this pair this edition.[3]
2-year Treasury	4.69%	+4bp	Thu 22 Oct base confirmed exact match to logged 4.65% — clean for a 14th straight edition.[18]
10-year Treasury	5.00%	+4bp	TextView and CSV endpoints agree exactly.[18]
30-year Treasury	5.33%	+4bp	Treasury Trading Economics cross-check passes within rounding.[18]

DXY and USD/JPY both rose Friday (dollar strength agreeing directionally across the index and the cross) — a 5th straight session of agreement.[3] Gold and silver both extended Thursday's decline into Friday on a stronger dollar and the broader risk-off tape, even as the Thursday base for both was again revised upward by the vendor, the second consecutive edition this has recurred for precious metals specifically.[3] The whole Treasury curve rose a uniform approx. 4bp, consistent with a modest rates-led (rather than growth-scare) tone into the FOMC.[18]

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The CBOE delayed-quotes feed returned a full, same-day clean sweep for Friday 23 Oct (all six series stamped with a Friday `last_trade_time`), but both of the feed's known bugs were present this time (a duplicated `prev_day_close` and a `price_change_percent` dividing by the current rather than prior price) — figures below are manually computed against Thursday's confirmed closes.[19] VIX rose +2.21% to 19.45, extending Thursday's +14.09% event-driven pop rather than reverting; the term structure stayed in contango (VIX9D 18.70 < VIX 19.45 < VIX3M 20.48 < VIX6M 21.96), and VVIX rose +1.63% to 109.70 while SKEW eased -0.39% to 151.80.[19] Dealer gamma remains fully unusable: zerogex.io logged a 10th straight failure (populated shell, no server-rendered data) and SpotGamma a 4th straight failure (confirmed client-side React app behind its login wall).[20] Single-stock options flow/skew commentary for Friday's earnings names was a 13th straight low-yield edition — nothing reliable found.[20] Funding: SOFR printed 3.90% (+2bp) and EFFR/OBFR 3.88% for Thursday 22 Oct, the latest available fixing; Friday's print had not yet published as of this edition's cutoff.[21]



CFTC's Friday 23 Oct release (3:30pm ET, covering Tuesday 20 Oct data — a two-business-day lag relative to the Friday print) is the first fresh update since 13 October.[8] ES open interest rose to 1,935,470 (+3,863) with Leveraged Funds covering a meaningful chunk of their net short (-19.2% of OI, in from approx. -21%) while Asset Managers trimmed their net long slightly to +46.6%. NQ open interest fell to 272,462 (-7,053), with Asset Managers holding the dominant net-long position (+28.6%) against an essentially flat Leveraged Funds book (+0.4%). RTY (full-size) open interest jumped to 466,789 (+22,005, the largest week-over-week OI move of the three), with Leveraged Funds the most net-short of the three indices (-11.4%) against a comparatively thin Asset Manager net long (+6.6%). The contrast — large-cap short-covering against still-net-short small-cap positioning — is the week's clearest positioning story and the basis for this edition's optional third chart.[8]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Tue 27 – Wed 28 Oct	FOMC meeting; decision approx. 2:00pm ET Wed, press conference approx. 2:30pm ET	Hold at 3.75%-4.00% priced at approx. 94%[6]
Wed 28 Oct, 9:45am ET	Bank of Canada decision + Monetary Policy Report	Current rate 2.25% going in; secondary odds lean hold[14]
Wed-Thu 28-29 Oct	ECB Governing Council decision	Current deposit rate 2.50%; date itself secondary-sourced[13]
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30am ET	Q3 2026 GDP, advance estimate (BEA)	No consensus figure sourced this edition
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30am ET	September 2026 PCE price index (BEA)	Per BEA's own release calendar; one secondary source suggested 4 Nov instead — BEA's calendar preferred[22]
Thu-Fri 29-30 Oct	Bank of Japan Monetary Policy Meeting, incl. quarterly Outlook Report	Current rate approx. 1.25% going in (secondary-sourced)[23]

Sector setup we take into the FOMC week

- Energy enters the week with two tailwinds stacked — a crude rally and an earnings beat (SLB) — worth watching for follow-through or a reversal once the FOMC/BoC/ECB triple-header is behind markets.
- Technology was the lone megacap-heavy sector to close green Friday after a volatile earnings week; Friday's CFTC data showing large-cap short-covering in ES/NQ is broadly consistent with that stabilization, though it does not isolate Technology specifically.
- Consumer Staples and Communication Services enter the week as the weakest sectors with no fresh, dateable catalyst identified for either — worth a dedicated look if the pattern persists into the FOMC week.

Annex A — Assumptions, corrections and status

- No correction to a previously published figure is logged this edition.
- Closed this edition: Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's exact term-end date (21 May 2030 for the Chairmanship; 31 Jan 2040 for his Board seat), open since edition 48.
- Closed this edition: the ECB's current policy rate (2.50% deposit facility), unresolved at edition 48 on a 2.00%-vs-2.40% conflict.
- Closed this edition: Bank of Canada's 28 Oct decision and 2.25% current rate, now primary-confirmed (previously secondary-sourced only).
- Closed this edition: LME copper's westmetall.com outage (edition 48) was transient; the source is back online and reinstated as primary, with COMEX retained as a cross-check.
- Still open: BoJ's exact numeric policy rate via readable primary HTML — a 5th straight failed edition; the statement PDF remains undecodable.
- Still open: Riksbank's exact rate text on a primary page — a working riksbank.se URL was found this edition (fixing edition 48's 404), but the rate figure itself was not extractable from it; approx. 1.75% remains secondary-corroborated only.
- Still open, 3rd straight edition: Equifax's Thursday 22 Oct +6.59% rally leg has no identified catalyst despite a dedicated SEC EDGAR search.
- Still open, 3rd straight edition: AT&T's Wednesday 21 Oct exact close (-6.45% vs. a third-party -6.1%) remains unresolved; now a secondary priority given Friday's larger, separately uncatalyzed -7.96% move.
- Still open, 3rd straight edition: whether New Mexico v. Meta's 9 Oct stay of enforcement extends to the $25bn judgment, and whether Meta has filed a formal notice of appeal.
- Norges Bank, Riksbank, SNB, RBA and Banxico's current rates are carried forward as settled (no contradicting news this window); their next-decision dates were not re-verified this edition — see Annex B.
- The CBOE VIX feed's two known bugs (duplicated prior close; percent-change dividing by the wrong base) were both present this edition after being absent at edition 48 — confirmed genuinely intermittent, not a one-way pattern. All percentages in this edition were computed manually against the prior session's confirmed close.
- Monthly audit due: the next edition covering the first NYSE session on or after 1 Nov 2026 should re-confirm the full settled-facts list directly against primary sources.

Annex B — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- AT&T's Friday 23 Oct -7.96% decline: no catalyst (downgrade, filing, news item) found despite a dedicated search.
- AT&T's exact Wednesday 21 Oct close: stockanalysis.com -6.45% vs. a third-party archive's -6.1%, unresolved for a 3rd straight edition.
- Equifax's Thursday 22 Oct +6.59% rally leg: no catalyst found on a 4th search pass, incl. SEC EDGAR full-text search.
- New Mexico v. Meta: whether the 9 Oct stay of enforcement extends to the $25bn judgment — unconfirmed.
- New Mexico v. Meta: whether Meta has filed a formal notice of appeal — unconfirmed.
- BoJ's exact numeric policy rate via a readable primary HTML page — 5th straight failed edition; approx. 1.25% is secondary-sourced only.
- Riksbank's exact policy-rate figure on its own (now-working) primary page — approx. 1.75% remains secondary-corroborated.
- Norges Bank, Riksbank, SNB, RBA and Banxico's next policy-decision dates — not re-verified this edition.
- ECB's exact next meeting date (approx. 28-29 Oct) — secondary-sourced only; direct ecb.europa.eu calendar fetch did not return a date.
- University of Michigan final October sentiment sub-indices (current conditions 46.7, expectations 48.8) — single-aggregator synthesis; umich.edu itself could not be fetched directly.
- BEA's Q3 GDP consensus estimate — not sourced this edition.
- Friday 23 Oct SOFR/EFFR/OBFR fixings — not yet published as of this edition's cutoff; Thursday 22 Oct is the latest available print.
- CBOE daily put/call ratio — the market-statistics page is client-side rendered with no numeric values in static markup.
- Dealer gamma (zerogex.io, SpotGamma) — both confirmed structurally unusable, 10th and 4th straight failed editions respectively.
- Official CME FedWatch probabilities — blocked, 9th straight failed edition; Kalshi direct — rate-limited, 13th straight failed edition.
- Henry Hub's exact Thursday 22 Oct close shows a small ($2.779 logged vs. $2.796 fresh) drift — immaterial but not fully reconciled.
- DXY's exact Thursday 22 Oct % change shows a small (-0.21% logged vs. -0.16/-0.17% fresh) drift — immaterial but not fully reconciled.
- CBRE, Roper Technologies, Nasdaq Inc., Dow Inc., PulteGroup, Freeport-McMoRan, Blackstone and Valero Energy's Thursday 22 Oct price moves — not individually investigated this edition, low priority.
- Low-priority micro-cap movers surfaced in a Friday aggregator sweep (GPUS, LUCD, SHFS, XXII) — flagged for completeness only, not independently chased for catalysts beyond their own same-day filings.

Annex C — Sources

- [1] stockanalysis.com ETF-proxy history (SPY/DIA/ONEQ/QQQ/IWM), cross-checked vs. StatMuse direct-index snapshots and FRED's NASDAQ100 series, Fri 23 Oct 2026.
- [2] stockanalysis.com SPDR sector-ETF price-history pages, all 11 sectors, Fri 23 Oct 2026.
- [3] Investing.com close-to-close historical-data tables, WTI, Brent, Henry Hub, gold/silver/copper futures, DXY, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY; home.treasury.gov and Trading Economics for yields; westmetall.com for LME copper; Kitco live spot for gold/silver cross-check.
- [4] stockanalysis.com single-stock closing-price history tables, verified against news coverage, Fri 23 Oct 2026.
- [5] federalreserve.gov/monetarypolicy/fomccalendars.htm, direct fetch.
- [6] defirate.com prediction-markets/Fed-decision-odds aggregator (Kalshi/Polymarket-blended), direct fetch.
- [7] ecb.europa.eu Governing Council calendar, secondary-corroborated meeting date.
- [8] cftc.gov/dea/futures/financial_lf.htm, Commitments of Traders, data as of Tue 20 Oct 2026, released Fri 23 Oct 2026.
- [9] Company 8-K filings, sec.gov (SLB, American Express, Bloom Energy), Q3 2026.
- [10] stockanalysis.com closing-price history (Equifax); SEC EDGAR full-text search for same-window 8-Ks.
- [11] Company investor-relations earnings calendars (Exxon Mobil, AbbVie, Newell Brands); SEC EDGAR filing search (Chevron).
- [12] News coverage of New Mexico v. Meta, incl. Meta counsel and New Mexico AG statements.
- [13] ecb.europa.eu/stats/policy_and_exchange_rates/key_ecb_interest_rates, direct fetch.
- [14] bankofcanada.ca, direct fetch, meeting schedule and current rate.
- [15] federalreserve.gov/aboutthefed/bios/board/warsh.htm, direct fetch.
- [16] Multi-outlet secondary corroboration of University of Michigan's final October 2026 Surveys of Consumers (umich.edu itself unreachable this edition).
- [17] whitehouse.gov/briefings-statements/2026/09/congressional-bill-h-r-6500/, direct fetch.
- [18] home.treasury.gov daily par-yield-curve TextView and CSV endpoints; Trading Economics cross-check.
- [19] CBOE cdn.cboe.com delayed-quotes JSON feed (VIX, VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW), direct fetch, Fri 23 Oct 2026.
- [20] zerogex.io and dashboard.spotgamma.com, direct fetch attempts (both unusable); general web search for single-stock options flow/skew commentary.
- [21] markets.newyorkfed.org rates API, direct fetch (SOFR/EFFR/OBFR).
- [22] bea.gov release calendar (BEA 26-36), Q3 GDP and September PCE release dates.
- [23] boj.or.jp/en/mopo/mpmdeci and mpmsche_minu pages; secondary corroboration (Jiji Press/nippon.com, MTS Insights) for the exact rate.

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex C; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex B. Not investment advice.